

RAJWANT RAWAT

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Strength of a Country

India's strength is its rich history and how it stops at nothing to create more;

India's strength is its diversity, which is both cultural and geographical;

India's strength is its defence forces that can shake its enemy to the core;

India's strength is how it endures hardships like none other and despite everything stands tall knowing that its people are always ready to catch her if she ever falls;

India's strength is its youth who are willing to fight for what is right, stopping at nothing to create a space where every life matters;

India's strength is the beautiful minds that it houses that will stop at nothing to make their motherland proud.

And...

My view of India and its future is one where we bring all these strengths together and prosper together as a nation and continue to create history. ■

SHYLA UPADHYAY, 16,
DELHI

Vasant Valley School, **Delhi**

TO THE PEOPLE OF INDIA...

Friends, Indians, countrymen, lend me your ears,
Yes, you too, the one in the 'I love NYC' shirt.
India needs your voices to be heard,
To prove its mettle, its very worth.
The saffron, white and green lace outer space,
Chandrayaan, Mangalyaan and maybe Brahaspatiyaan too.
But astronauts won't be the only ones wearing space helmets.
India, the land of unity in diversity,
With different languages and cultures.
There's diversity even in the animals we fight for,
Cows, pigs or buffaloes? It's a whole lot of fun.
This is an India with many triumphs,
But we can't mend shortcomings while making a fuss.
So, let's come together,
And make this our India—the story of us. ■